



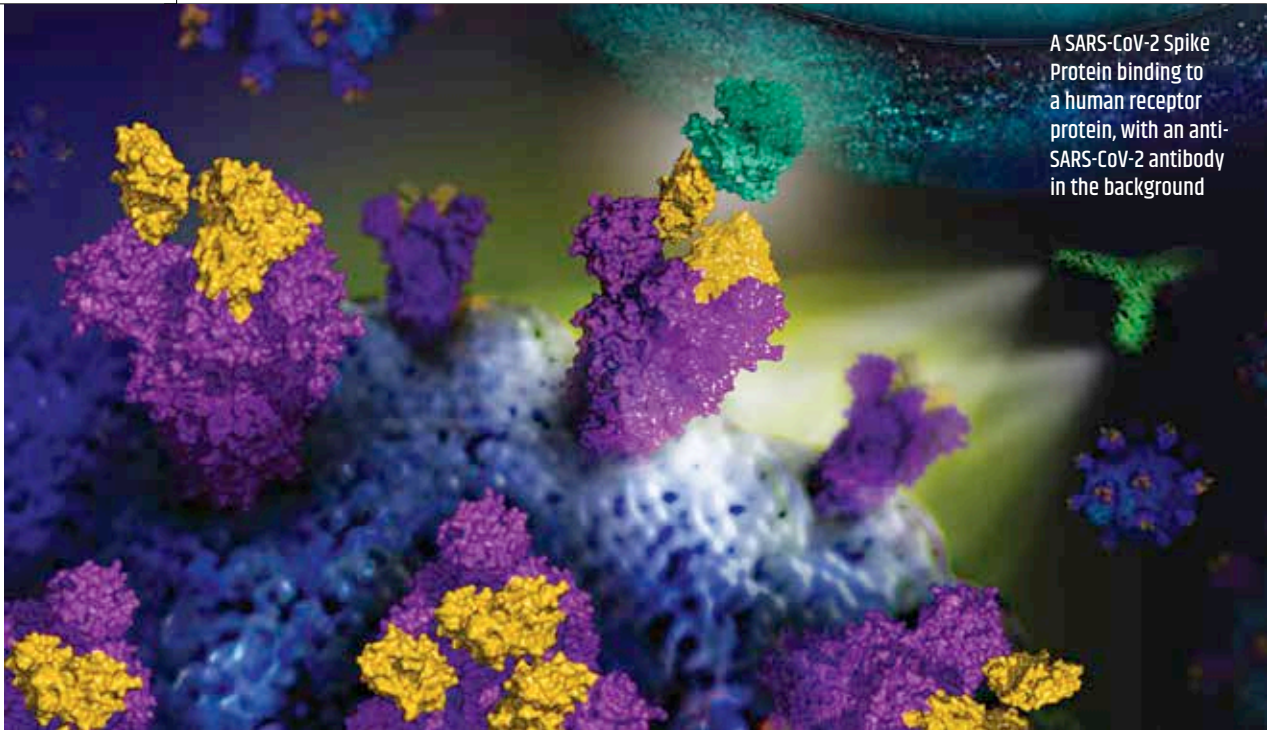
Statins for treatment

A study has shown that drugs for treating those with high cholesterol can be repurposed to fight the outbreak. <http://digit.in/sep20-55>



Finding new therapies

Researchers have used simulations to find preexisting drugs that can be effective against COVID-19. <http://digit.in/sep20-56>



A SARS-CoV-2 Spike Protein binding to a human receptor protein, with an anti-SARS-CoV-2 antibody in the background

Credit: Rajani Arora/University of Michigan

FIGHTING THE PANDEMIC

The research directions to stop the spread of the novel coronavirus

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he focus of most of the research for fighting the coronavirus is the development of a safe and

effective vaccine. Around the world, many research institutions and pharmaceutical companies are racing against the spread of the virus, and there are over 200 vaccine candidates

in development. But apart from the development of a vaccine, there are a number of research directions to tackle the virus. This includes developing cheaper, faster, and reliable tests, understanding the effects of the virus itself better, and fighting the pandemic with the help of technologies. Like those developing the vaccine, these researchers are working practically around the clock too. Here is a look at some of the latest research in tackling the pandemic. To get the terminology cleared, SARS-CoV-2 is the virus itself, while COVID-19 is the disease it causes.

DEVELOPING BETTER TESTS

A novel virus needs novel approaches, which is what researchers from the University of Ohio have done by

developing a device that can do away with the painful and invasive nasal or throat swabs used for testing today. The device is a breathalyzer, that analyses the breath of a person for the presence of nitric oxide and particular volatile organic compounds, which can together be signs of infection by the SARS-CoV-2 virus. The device was already in development for the detection of early onset of the flu, but was modified to detect infection by the novel coronavirus. The low cost detector gives a result within fifteen minutes.

Apart from testing if the person carries the virus itself, another kind of test is to check if a person has developed the antibodies to fight the SARS-CoV-2 virus. These kinds of tests are called serological tests, and